csvtrim

A small Python script that strips leading and trailing whitespace from every cell of a CSV file and drops rows that are completely empty.

It uses only the standard library and needs Python 3 (f-strings are used, so 3.6 or later).

Usage

```
python3 csvtrim.py INPUT [-o OUTPUT] [--delimiter CHAR] [--keep-empty]
```

Option	Meaning
`INPUT`	CSV file to read (UTF-8).
`-o`, `--output`	Write to this file instead of standard output. An existing file is overwritten.
`--delimiter`	Field delimiter for both input and output. Default `,`.
`--keep-empty`	Keep rows that are completely empty (cells are still trimmed).

The count of dropped rows is printed to standard error, so it does not mix with CSV on standard output.

Example

`sample.csv`:

```
name , city ,age
  Ana ,Lisbon , 31

 Ben,  Oslo,27
,,
```

```
$ python3 csvtrim.py sample.csv
csvtrim: dropped 2 empty rows
name,city,age
Ana,Lisbon,31
Ben,Oslo,27
```

Behavior to know about

- A row counts as empty when every cell is blank after trimming. A blank line and a row like `,,` are both dropped.

- Output always uses `\n` line endings and the csv module's default quoting, so quoting may differ from the input.
- If the input file does not exist, it prints `csvtrim: no such file: <path>` to standard error and exits with status 2.
- Do not set `-o` to the same path as the input: the output file is opened after the input is read, but it is overwritten without asking.

Tests

```
python3 -m unittest
```

The tests cover the `trim()` function in `test_csvtrim.py`. The command-line handling is not tested.